

CASE ID: 202312710002a

EPISODE NAME: China restricts graphite and other rare earths

2023/12/01 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: Deny Strategic Materials (6)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Summary:

On, 2023/12/01, China imposed export restrictions on graphite products after the United States expanded export controls on semiconductor-related products on 2023/10/17. Beijing also banned the export of rare earth processing technology on 2023/12/22. These restrictions are still in place and the episode is ongoing.

Narrative:

On 2023/12/01, China began requiring Chinese corporations to obtain dual-use export permits for graphite-related products used in making batteries.¹ The decision followed an expansion in the US export control regime intended to curb China's access to AI chips.² China framed the decision as a national security measure, with the ministry of Commerce calling the restrictions "conducive to better safeguarding national security and interests."³ US analysts saw the measure as a retaliation, as the decision to impose the restrictions was announced three days after the US expanded its export control regime.⁴

This episode is part of an ongoing campaign of semiconductor related export controls that began with the US export controls on 2022/10/07.⁵

These restrictions are still in place and the episode is ongoing.

¹ Siyi Liu and Dominique Patton. "China, world's top graphite producer, tightens exports of key battery material." *Reuters*, 20 Oct. 2013.

<https://www.reuters.com/world/china/china-require-export-permits-some-graphite-products-dec-1-2023-10-20/>

² Ana Swanson. "U.S. Tightens China's Access to Advanced Chips for Artificial Intelligence." *New York Times*, 17 Oct. 2023. <https://www.nytimes.com/2023/10/17/business/economy/ai-chips-china-restrictions.html>

³ Siyi Liu and Dominique Patton. "China, world's top graphite producer, tightens exports of key battery material." *Reuters*, 20 Oct. 2013.

<https://www.reuters.com/world/china/china-require-export-permits-some-graphite-products-dec-1-2023-10-20/>

⁴ Benson, Emily and Thibault Denamiel. "China's New Graphite Restrictions." *Center for Strategic and International Studies*, 23 October 2023. <https://www.csis.org/analysis/chinas-new-graphite-restrictions>

⁵ Swanson, Ana. "Biden Administration Clamps Down on China's Access to Chip Technology." *New York Times*, 7 Oct. 2022. <https://www.nytimes.com/2022/10/07/business/economy/biden-chip-technology.html>